



sheets or voice notes converted into text.

Second, it should organise information. It should turn messy inputs into labelled sections, priority lists, tables, folders, tasks or summaries.

Third, it should draft useful outputs. These may be emails, reports, social posts, project updates, study plans, checklists, proposals or article outlines.

Fourth, it should help you review decisions. It should show assumptions, risks, missing information and items that need your approval.

What it should not do, at least in the beginning, is act without you. Do not let your first agent system send emails, make payments, delete files, publish posts, share documents, book tickets or update important records automatically. Your first system should assist, not control.

Three-part foundation

Every personal agent system needs three foundations: a workspace, a prompt library and a rules document.

The workspace is where the agent gets information. This may be a folder in Google Drive, OneDrive, Notion, Obsidian, a local folder, or even a simple set of documents you upload manually. Keep it clean. Put only the files the agent is allowed to use.

The prompt library is where you save repeatable instructions. Instead of rewriting the same prompt every week, create templates: “summarise meeting,” “draft follow-up,” “analyse spreadsheet,” “create study plan,” “review article,” “prepare weekly report.”

The rules document tells the agent how to behave. It includes your tone, preferred formats, approval rules, banned actions, privacy limits and output style. This document is the constitution of your personal agent system.

Step-by-Step: Set up your AI workspace

Step 1: Create an AI-ready folder

Make a folder called “AI Agent Workspace.” Inside it, create sub-

folders such as Notes, Documents, Templates, Drafts, Research, Reports and Archive. For students, add Syllabus, Assignments and Revision. For freelancers, add Clients, Proposals and Invoices. For creators, add Ideas, Scripts and Analytics.

Step 2: Add only safe files

Do not dump your entire digital life into this folder. Add only files you are comfortable using with an AI tool. Remove Aadhaar, PAN, bank statements, confidential contracts, medical records, passwords, API keys and private client information unless you are using an approved secure environment.

Step 3: Rename files clearly

Agents perform better when file names make sense. “Physics-Chapter-3-Notes” is better than “scan0007.” “Client-Proposal-Draft-July-2026” is better than “final-new-latest.” Clear naming reduces confusion.

Step 4: Add a README file

Create a simple text file called “Read-Me-First.” Explain what the folder contains, what should be ignored, what the agent is allowed to do, and what it must never do.

Step 5: Keep an Archive folder

Move old drafts and outdated files into Archive. Agents can get confused when they see too many versions. If there is a final source of truth, label it clearly.



Write your personal agent rules

Your rules document should be short but strict. It should tell the agent how to work with you.

Use this starter version:

“You are my personal admin and workflow assistant. Your job is to organise information, summarise documents, draft outputs, create task lists and help me review decisions. Do not send emails, publish posts, delete files, make purchases, share personal information, edit original files or take irreversible actions unless I explicitly approve. When uncertain, ask. Always show assumptions. Always